

BENZALKONIUM CHLORIDE

_____Name

_____Date

*also called...*alkylbenzyltrimethylammonium chloride or alkyltrimethylbenzylammonium chloride.

What is it?

Benzalkonium chloride is an antiseptic and detergent.

Where might it be found?

Contact lens solutions
Eye drops
Artificial tears
Nose drops
Facial cleanser, exfoliant
Toner, skin mist
Moisturizer
Baby lotion, diaper cream
Antiwrinkle treatment
Night cream
Acne wash, scrub, blemish gel
Sun protective lotion
Deodorants
Mouthwashes, lozenges
Dentifrices, teething pain salve
Anti-itch cream
Burn, ulcer, wound treatment
First aid pain, bite, sting spray
Skin antiseptic wash, swab
Ear piercing solution
Hygienic towelettes
Feminine moisturizer
Antibacterial soap, sanitizer
Wet wipes, moistened cloths
Surface cleaner
Disinfectant, e.g. Lysol
Preoperative skin disinfectant
Instrument sterilization solution
Plaster of Paris cast material
Swimming pool algicide
Pool, pond, reservoir slimeicide
Diaper service, hospital laundry

*[Brands containing it include
Amino-Cerv, Bactine, Beniol,
Cetylclide, Clens, Enuclene,
Germitol, Liquifilm, Medi-Quik,
Mercurochrome II, Opcon A,
NTZ, and Zephiran.]*

Some industrial uses:

Fabrication of textiles and dyes
Metallurgy
Agriculture

How to avoid it:

To avoid **benzalkonium chloride** check the complete ingredient list of each product you use. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

Tell your eye doctor about this allergy. Ask those involved in your care to avoid using products with benzalkonium chloride on you.

To identify possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list for all products encountered. Wear protective rubber or vinyl gloves if you cannot avoid hand contact with this substance.

Benzalkonium chloride is only rarely an allergen. It can cause skin irritation, especially when applied to damaged skin. Your doctor may suggest you do a Repeat Open Application Test (ROAT) with your product that contains this ingredient to guide recommendations.

Allergic persons may show cross-sensitivity to related quaternary ammonium antiseptics **benzethonium chloride** and **cetrimonium bromide**.